

# Green Valley Community Hospital

Insurance Desk

## Insurance and Cashless Policy

|                  |                |              |                                 |
|------------------|----------------|--------------|---------------------------------|
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### Purpose

This policy explains how patients with insurance coverage can request cashless treatment at Green Valley Community Hospital, and what happens when insurance approval is delayed, partial, or unavailable. All insurance rules described here are fictional and created for this demonstration only.

### Scope

This policy applies to any patient who wishes to use insurance coverage, whether through a cashless request or through reimbursement after payment. It also applies to family members coordinating insurance matters on a patient's behalf.

### Key Terms

A few simple terms are used throughout this policy so that patients understand how the insurance process works.

| Term                   | Meaning                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cashless request       | A request sent by the hospital to an insurance provider, asking it to pay the hospital directly instead of the patient paying up front. |
| Insurance approval     | Confirmation from the insurance provider that some or all of a cashless request will be paid.                                           |
| Coverage confirmation  | A message from the insurance provider stating what portion of the treatment cost is covered.                                            |
| Patient responsibility | The portion of the bill that is not covered by insurance and must be paid by the patient.                                               |

### Insurance Desk and Insurance Identification

The Insurance Desk is located next to the admission area and assists patients with all cashless and insurance-related questions. Patients wishing to use insurance should visit the Insurance Desk as early as possible during their visit, ideally at the time of registration.

Patients should bring their insurance card and any related identification documents so the Insurance Desk can begin verifying coverage.

## Cashless Request Procedure

When a patient requests cashless treatment, the Insurance Desk follows a simple sequence of steps to communicate with the insurance provider.

- 1 The Insurance Desk collects the patient's insurance card and basic treatment information.
- 2 A cashless request is sent to the insurance provider, describing the expected treatment and estimated cost.
- 3 The insurance provider reviews the request and sends back a coverage confirmation, which may approve the full amount, part of the amount, or request more information.
- 4 The Insurance Desk shares the outcome with the patient and updates the billing desk so that charges reflect the confirmed coverage.

## Required Documents for Insurance Verification

To begin a cashless request, the Insurance Desk generally needs the following documents.

- A valid insurance card or policy document.
- Patient identification matching the name on the insurance card.
- The patient reference number issued during registration.
- Any prior approval or referral documents, if applicable to the patient's insurance provider.

## Scenario 1: Insurance Information Is Complete

When a patient provides a valid insurance card and all required documents at registration, the Insurance Desk can usually submit the cashless request the same day. In this situation, the patient does not need to make an upfront payment for the portion expected to be covered, once the insurance provider confirms approval.

## Scenario 2: Insurance Approval Is Delayed

Sometimes an insurance provider takes longer than expected to respond to a cashless request. If insurance approval is delayed, the Insurance Desk continues to follow up with the insurance provider and keeps the patient informed of the status.

During a delay, the billing desk may request a temporary deposit to allow treatment to continue without interruption. This deposit is adjusted once the insurance provider's decision is received.

## Scenario 3: Partial Approval

In some cases, the insurer approves only part of a requested amount. When this happens, the Insurance Desk explains which charges are covered and which charges become the patient's responsibility. The billing desk then updates the patient's bill to reflect the confirmed coverage and the remaining balance.

## Scenario 4: Missing Insurance Document

If a patient does not have the required insurance document available, the Insurance Desk can still begin basic verification using the information available, but the cashless request cannot be finalized until the missing document is provided. In this situation, the patient may be asked to pay for treatment upfront and later submit the charges to their insurance provider for reimbursement, using the receipts issued by the billing desk.

## Non-Covered Charges and Patient Responsibility

Not all charges are always covered by insurance. Charges that fall outside a patient's coverage, such as certain optional services, become the patient's responsibility. The Insurance Desk will explain any non-covered charges before they are added to the final bill, whenever possible.

## Insurance Claim Documents and Final Claim Submission

Patients using reimbursement, rather than a cashless request, should keep all receipts, discharge documents, and billing statements. The Insurance Desk can prepare a summary of administrative charges to support the patient's own claim submission to their insurance provider.

For cashless cases, the final claim is submitted to the insurance provider by the Insurance Desk after discharge, once the final bill has been prepared by the billing desk.

## Communication With the Insurance Provider

The Insurance Desk communicates with insurance providers by phone, secure email, or an online provider portal, depending on what each insurance provider supports. Patients are not usually required to contact the insurance provider directly while the Insurance Desk is handling a cashless request, though they are welcome to do so if they wish to check on their policy details independently.

The Insurance Desk keeps a simple status log for each cashless request, noting when the request was submitted, when a response was received, and what the outcome was. Patients can ask to see a summary of this status log at any time.

## Responsibilities

The Insurance Desk is responsible for submitting cashless requests, communicating with insurance providers, and keeping patients informed of the status of their request. Patients are responsible for providing accurate insurance information and required documents.

The billing desk and the Insurance Desk work together closely, since insurance decisions directly affect the charges shown on a patient's bill. Patients with questions that touch both areas can start at either desk, and staff will coordinate internally.

## Exceptions

In emergency situations, treatment begins before insurance verification is complete. The Insurance Desk will begin the cashless process as soon as the patient's condition is stable and the required documents can be collected.

## Frequently Asked Questions

### **Q: What is needed for an insurance verification request?**

A: A valid insurance card, matching patient identification, the patient reference number, and any prior approval documents required by the insurance provider.

### **Q: What happens if insurance approval is delayed?**

A: The Insurance Desk continues to follow up with the provider and keeps the patient informed. A temporary deposit may be requested until approval is received.

### **Q: What happens if only part of a claim is approved?**

A: The Insurance Desk explains which charges are covered, and the billing desk updates the bill so the remaining balance becomes the patient's responsibility.

**Q: What documents should patients keep for insurance?**

A: Patients should keep all receipts, discharge documents, and billing statements, especially if they are using reimbursement instead of a cashless request.

**Q: What happens if I do not have my insurance document?**

A: The Insurance Desk can begin basic verification, but the cashless request cannot be finalized until the missing document is provided. Patients may need to pay upfront and seek reimbursement afterward.

**Contact Information**

For general questions about this policy, please contact the Administrative Services Desk.

| Contact Point                | Details                                               |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Administrative Services Desk | +1-555-010-2400                                       |
| General Email                | info@greenvalleyhospital.example                      |
| Hospital Address             | 25 Green Valley Road, Riverside District, New Harmony |
| Desk Hours                   | Monday to Saturday, 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM                |